Reading a Past Label versus Updating a Surface Record: An Explicit Bulk–Boundary Example

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Abstract

A surface observable may distinguish a selected past label without containing enough information to predict its response to another input. We exhibit this distinction in a massless real wave field on a half-line coupled to a dynamical boundary coordinate. An exact reduction to a forced linear oscillator gives two ideal equal-energy pulse-order preparations whose scalar surface readouts remain separated on a specified finite interval under bounded scalar observation error. On a broader reachable family, the same scalar fails to determine its next value under a common pulse: a missing field–rate orientation enters the update. A two-component record relative to a supplied phase reference admits a closed update when the next input is specified. We state the different preparation families and access assumptions explicitly. Motivated by a broader question in Field 01, this is a self-contained methodological example of readable content versus predictive sufficiency, not a test of the cosmological proposal, a new principle of state reduction, or a mechanism of autonomous, persistent physical memory.

1 Model, access and the question

1.1 Two tasks for a record

Consider two questions about an observable left after an incident pulse. Can it identify which member of a declared preparation family was used? Can it also determine its own value after a further specified pulse? The first question concerns a chosen past label; the second concerns closure under subsequent dynamics. They have different quantifiers. A successful decoder on two preparations need not provide a state representation for all possible histories.

We study these questions in a fixed linear bulk–boundary model. The positive result is an equal-energy order code. The negative result uses a larger family to expose information lost by a scalar observation. A sufficient enlarged record then restores controlled closure. These are three statements about explicitly stated families, not contradictory claims about the same two states. The response formulas, reachability construction and decoding margin are derived analytically below.

The question is motivated by Field 01's broader recursive-recording programme. That programme supplies the motivation, not the equations: the action, preparation family and observables below are specified and analysed on their own. A successful finite-time decoder is therefore a result about this boundary-oscillator model, not evidence for a cosmological memory law or for the validity of Model 01.

The underlying ingredients have established precedents. A wave field coupled to a boundary oscillator is a known model class[1]. Linear propagation with prescribed inputs is standard state-space dynamics[5]. Exact lumpability formalizes compatible state reduction[6], while causal-state constructions study predictive sufficiency and its input–output version[7, 8]. The present contribution is an explicit comparison of access rules in one solvable preparation protocol; no

general novelty claim is attached to those ingredients. Section 4 makes the comparisons and the limits precise.

1.2 A real bulk field and a dynamical boundary

Let $u(t,x)$ be real on $x \le 0$, and let $q(t)$ be an independent real boundary coordinate. The propagation speed is one. For fixed positive parameters K, M, g, take the action

$$S = \int dt \left\{ \frac{K}{2} \int_{-\infty}^{0} (u_t^2 - u_x^2)\, dx + \frac{M}{2}\dot{q}^2 - \frac{g}{2}(q - u(t,0))^2 \right\}. \tag{1}$$

There is no bulk mass or separate surface potential. This is a specified model, not an approximation obtained by dropping terms during the calculation. One may also regard it as the tangentially constant sector of a flat half-cylinder with finite transverse area. In that reading, all displayed energies are per unit transverse area.

Write $v(t) = u(t,0)$ and take the outward normal at the endpoint to point in the positive x direction. Variations vanish at the temporal endpoints and are compactly supported in space, but their boundary values are free. Integration by parts gives the boundary coefficients $-Ku_x - g(v-q)$ for δv and $-M\ddot{q} - g(q-v)$ for δq. Thus the equations are

$$u_{tt} - u_{xx} = 0, \qquad x < 0, \tag{2}$$

$$Ku_x(t,0) + g(v-q) = 0, \tag{3}$$

$$M\ddot{q} + g(q-v) = 0. \tag{4}$$

The endpoint is fixed and timelike; no moving geometry is being inferred. The boundary variable is not identified with the trace of the bulk field.

The nonnegative energy is

$$E(t) = \frac{K}{2} \int_{-\infty}^{0} (u_t^2 + u_x^2)\, dx + \frac{M}{2}\dot{q}^2 + \frac{g}{2}(q-v)^2. \tag{5}$$

For smooth fields with no flux at spatial infinity at finite time,

$$\dot{E}_{\text{bulk}} = Kv_t u_x(t,0),$$
$$\dot{E}_{\Sigma} = M\dot{q}\ddot{q} + g(q-v)(\dot{q} - \dot{v}) = g(v-q)\dot{v}.$$

The Robin equation cancels these two terms. The trace v enters the surface interaction energy; later we will use a surface-only readout which is not this energy.

1.3 Causal pulse preparations and their exact evolution

An admissible incident profile F is a real C^3 function of compact support in $[0, T_F]$, extended by zero, with its derivatives through order three vanishing at support endpoints. Finite sums of separated pulses with this property are admitted. Prepare

$$u(0,x) = F(-x), \qquad u_t(0,x) = F'(-x), \qquad q(0) = \dot{q}(0) = 0. \tag{6}$$

The compatibility conditions at the boundary hold at $t = 0$. All future incident pulses in F are already encoded in these initial bulk data; there is no later boundary work used to choose their order.

Define

$$\gamma = \frac{g}{K}, \qquad \omega_*^2 = \frac{g}{M}, \qquad \Omega^2 = \omega_*^2 - \frac{\gamma^2}{4}. \tag{7}$$

From here on assume the underdamped condition $\Omega^2 > 0$. The causal kernel of $\partial_t^2 + \gamma\partial_t + \omega_*^2$ is

$$G(t) = e^{-\gamma t/2} \frac{\sin(\Omega t)}{\Omega} \quad (t \ge 0), \qquad G(t) = 0 \quad (t < 0). \tag{8}$$

Proposition 1.1 (Exact pulse response)**.** *For the data* (6)*, the unique classical causal solution is*

$$q(t) = 2\omega_*^2 \int_0^t G(t-s)F(s)\,ds, \tag{9}$$

$$h(t) = F(t) - \frac{M}{K}\dot{q}(t), \tag{10}$$

$$u(t,x) = F(t-x) + h(t+x), \tag{11}$$

where h is zero at negative arguments. In particular,

$$\ddot{q} + \gamma\dot{q} + \omega_*^2 q = 2\omega_*^2 F. \tag{12}$$

Uniqueness is within the smooth finite-energy class with the prescribed initial data and no additional incoming excitation.

Proof. The characteristic decomposition solves the bulk wave equation. At the boundary $v = F+h$ and $u_x = -F' + h'$, so the Robin equation is $\dot{v} = 2F' - \gamma(v-q)$. The surface equation gives $\ddot{q} = \omega_*^2(v-q)$. Differentiating and eliminating v yields

$$\dddot{q} + \gamma\ddot{q} + \omega_*^2\dot{q} = 2\omega_*^2 F'.$$

Initially $v = q = \ddot{q} = F = 0$, so its integration constant is zero. This proves (12). The kernel has $G(0) = 0$, $G'(0+) = 1$, and solves the homogeneous equation at positive times, which proves the convolution formula. The oscillator equation then gives $v = q + \ddot{q}/\omega_*^2 = 2F - (M/K)\dot{q}$, hence the stated h. These identities verify both boundary equations. Zero extension and endpoint regularity give the required initial data and classical matching. The incoming characteristic is fixed by (6); the ordinary differential equation with zero initial data fixes q, and then h. This also proves uniqueness in the declared class. □

The reduction is exact for the admitted data. It is not an instantaneous kick approximation or a phenomenological insertion of damping. The half-line permits an outgoing wave to leave without returning.

Proposition 1.2 (Conserved total energy and a decaying boundary response)**.** *For* (11)*,*

$$E_{\mathrm{bulk}}(t) = K\int_t^\infty F'(s)^2\,ds + K\int_0^t h'(s)^2\,ds, \tag{13}$$

$$E_\Sigma(t) = \frac{M}{2}\dot{q}^2 + \frac{M^2}{2g}\ddot{q}^2, \tag{14}$$

$$\dot{E}_\Sigma = K(F'^2 - h'^2), \tag{15}$$

$$E(t) = K\int_0^{T_F} F'(s)^2\,ds. \tag{16}$$

After the last incident pulse, q, $\dot{q}$, $\ddot{q}$ and E_Σ tend to zero as $t \to \infty$.

Proof. Since $u_t = F' + h'$ and $u_x = -F' + h'$, their squared sum is $2(F'^2 + h'^2)$. Changing variables in the half-line integrals gives the first identity. Substituting $q - v = -\ddot{q}/\omega_*^2$ gives the second. Differentiation, using the derivative of (12), gives

$$\begin{aligned}\dot{E}_\Sigma &= 2MF'\ddot{q} - \frac{M^2}{K}\ddot{q}^2 \\ &= K\big[F'^2 - (F' - (M/K)\ddot{q})^2\big].\end{aligned}$$

This is the third identity, which cancels the derivative of the bulk energy. Evaluation at zero proves the last identity. After T_F the oscillator has roots $-\gamma/2 \pm i\Omega$, so the coordinate and its first two derivatives decay. The expression for E_Σ finishes the proof. □

Thus surface decay and conservation of the full energy coexist. The energy has entered the outgoing bulk wave rather than disappeared. The conclusion depends on the declared geometry and preparation; a reflecting far boundary would supply a returning input.

1.4 Reading and updating as factorization problems

Let X be a declared set of states, $m : X \to \mathcal{Z}$ a selected past label, and $\mathsf{b} : X \to \mathcal{Y}$ an accessible record. A decoder exists exactly when

$$\mathsf{b}(x_1) = \mathsf{b}(x_2) \implies m(x_1) = m(x_2). \tag{17}$$

Indeed, a decoder d with $m = d \circ \mathsf{b}$ implies the condition; conversely define $d(\mathsf{b}(x)) = m(x)$. The condition makes this independent of the representative. Only the chosen label, not the entire history or state, must be recovered.

For a fixed input ι, let $T_\iota : X \to X$ be a state update. A closed record update U_ι exists precisely when

$$\mathsf{b}(x_1) = \mathsf{b}(x_2) \implies \mathsf{b}(T_\iota x_1) = \mathsf{b}(T_\iota x_2). \tag{18}$$

The proof is the same: set $U_\iota(\mathsf{b}(x)) = \mathsf{b}(T_\iota x)$. For an autonomous semigroup T_t, if this holds for every t, the induced updates form a semigroup because $U_s U_t \mathsf{b} = \mathsf{b} T_s T_t = U_{s+t}\mathsf{b}$ and b is onto its image. No continuity or numerical stability follows merely from this set-theoretic argument. It is the elementary factorization underlying the more structured smooth reduction studied in Ref. [6, Section 2.2].

2 Equal-energy labels and a finite reading window

2.1 A surface observable and the transfer matrix

Assume access to q and its time rate, and define

$$z = \begin{pmatrix} \Omega q \\ \dot{q} + \gamma q/2 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad Y = \|z\|^2 = (\dot{q} + \gamma q/2)^2 + \Omega^2 q^2. \tag{19}$$

Both quantities use no instantaneous bulk trace. The scalar is invariant under a simultaneous sign change of the real field and its rate; Section 3.2 supplies its gauge-covariant description. Access to the two ingredients of Y is explicitly broader than access to q^2 alone. A nonzero underdamped free solution has recurring zeros of q, whereas Y below has no such blind times.

Equation (12) becomes

$$\dot{z} = Lz + kF(t), \qquad L = \begin{pmatrix} -\gamma/2 & \Omega \\ -\Omega & -\gamma/2 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad k = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 2\omega_*^2 \end{pmatrix}. \tag{20}$$

Direct differentiation verifies

$$\Phi(s) = e^{-\gamma s/2} \begin{pmatrix} \cos(\Omega s) & \sin(\Omega s) \\ -\sin(\Omega s) & \cos(\Omega s) \end{pmatrix}, \tag{21}$$

$$\Phi(s+t) = \Phi(s)\Phi(t), \qquad \Phi(s)^{\mathsf{T}}\Phi(s) = e^{-\gamma s} I. \tag{22}$$

Consequently $Y(t_p + s) = e^{-\gamma s} Y(t_p)$ whenever no incident input is present after t_p. More generally,

$$z(t) = \Phi(t - t_0) z(t_0) + \int_{t_0}^{t} \Phi(t - s) k F(s)\, ds. \tag{23}$$

This is the usual linear state-space solution[5], here verified by differentiation and the initial value at t_0.

Fix a base pulse f supported in $[0, T]$ and write

$$c = \int_0^T \Phi(T - s) k f(s)\, ds, \qquad C_* = \|c\|^2. \tag{24}$$

We require $C_* > 0$. Nonzero input alone would not establish this: the terminal integral could cancel for some waveforms. The explicit pulse used below has a proved positive lower bound.

2.2 Two orders with equal initial energy

Choose $0 < a < b$ and $\Delta \geq T$. The inputs are

$$F_{ab}(t) = af(t) + bf(t-\Delta), \tag{25}$$
$$F_{ba}(t) = bf(t) + af(t-\Delta), \qquad t_p = T + \Delta. \tag{26}$$

Their differentiated supports are disjoint except at vanishing endpoints. Proposition 1.2 therefore gives

$$E_{ab} = E_{ba} = (a^2 + b^2)E_f, \qquad E_f = K\int_0^T f'(s)^2\, ds. \tag{27}$$

Equal energy does not mean equal preparation. The spatial distribution of the initial bulk pulses encodes their order with respect to the supplied clock. For this pair even the modulus profiles on the separated supports differ, so a phase transformation does not identify the preparations.

Proposition 2.1 (Equal-energy order readout)**.** *Let f be an admissible pulse with $C_* > 0$, let $0 < a < b$ and $\Delta \geq T$, and assume $\Omega^2 > 0$. For the two ideal preparations* (26)*, with no further incoming pulse after $t_p = T + \Delta$, every $t \geq t_p$ satisfies*

$$Y_{ab}(t) - Y_{ba}(t) = (b^2 - a^2)(1 - e^{-\gamma\Delta})C_* e^{-\gamma(t-t_p)} > 0. \tag{28}$$

Proof. At t_p, the first pulse response has propagated freely for Δ more units of time than the second, so

$$z_{ab} = a\Phi(\Delta)c + bc, \qquad z_{ba} = b\Phi(\Delta)c + ac.$$

Set $\rho = e^{-\gamma\Delta/2}$ and $\vartheta = \Omega\Delta$. Since $c^{\mathsf{T}}\Phi(\Delta)c = \rho\cos\vartheta\, C_*$,

$$Y_{ab}(t_p) = C_*(a^2\rho^2 + b^2 + 2ab\rho\cos\vartheta),$$
$$Y_{ba}(t_p) = C_*(b^2\rho^2 + a^2 + 2ab\rho\cos\vartheta).$$

The cross terms cancel, leaving $(b^2 - a^2)(1 - \rho^2)C_*$. Free propagation multiplies both squared norms by $e^{-\gamma(t-t_p)}$, proving (28). □

The algebra identifies the mechanism: the earlier contribution has aged more before the common reading time. A quadratic scalar readout retains this difference even when the total input energies coincide. No nonlinearity of the evolution is needed.

2.3 A bounded-error decoder

At a known time t, suppose the measured value is $\widetilde{Y} = Y_j(t) + \eta$, where $j \in \{ab, ba\}$ and $|\eta| \leq \delta$. The decoder knows the parameters, pulse shape, amplitudes and time. Calibration uncertainty, if present, must be included in the declared scalar bound; it is not silently set to zero after being incurred.

Lemma 2.2 (Separation of reading intervals)**.** *A decoder correct for both labels and every allowed scalar error exists if and only if $|Y_{ab}(t) - Y_{ba}(t)| > 2\delta$. If the two calibrated signals are continuous on a compact interval, correctness at every specified time in that interval is equivalent to their minimum separation being strictly greater than 2δ.*

Proof. The allowed readings are the closed intervals $[Y_j(t) - \delta, Y_j(t) + \delta]$. They are disjoint exactly under the strict inequality; their touching endpoint at equality is already ambiguous. If disjoint, comparing with the midpoint of the centres decodes the two labels. Continuity on a compact interval makes the minimum attainable, proving the uniform assertion. □

With $D_0 = (b^2 - a^2)(1 - e^{-\gamma\Delta})C_*$, the decreasing gap makes its value at the last reading time the relevant one. For $\delta > 0$ and $D_0 > 2\delta$, the strict deadline is

$$t < t_p + \frac{1}{\gamma} \log \frac{D_0}{2\delta}. \tag{29}$$

If $D_0 \le 2\delta$, no post-pulse time meets this error criterion. When $\delta = 0$, the labels remain distinct at every finite time, but their asymptotic gap is still zero. A noise-dependent decoding deadline and an asymptotically nonzero residual are different claims.

2.4 One explicit analytic margin

Choose dimensionless parameters $K = M = g = 1$ and $T = 1$. This selects a coupling ratio $gM/K^2 = 1$; it is not merely a change of units removing all possible dimensionless parameters. Let

$$f(t) = 256t^4(1-t)^4 \quad (0 \le t \le 1), \qquad f(t) = 0 \quad \text{otherwise.} \tag{30}$$

The zero extension is C^3. The derivative is $f'(t) = 1024t^3(1-t)^3(1-2t)$. Expanding $(1-2t)^2$ and integrating monomials, or repeatedly integrating by parts, gives

$$E_f = 2^{20} \int_0^1 t^6(1-t)^6(1-2t)^2\, dt = \frac{262144}{45045}, \tag{31}$$

$$\int_0^1 (1-s) f(s)\, ds = 256 \frac{4!\,5!}{10!} = \frac{64}{315}. \tag{32}$$

Here the elementary identity $\int_0^1 t^m(1-t)^n\, dt = m!n!/(m+n+1)!$ for nonnegative integers follows by integration by parts in n followed by integrating t^{m+n}.

For $0 \le z \le \sqrt{3}/2$, integration of $\cos z \ge 1 - z^2/2$ gives $\sin z \ge z - z^3/6 \ge 7z/8$. Hence, for $0 \le r \le 1$,

$$G(r) = e^{-r/2} \frac{\sin((\sqrt{3}/2)r)}{\sqrt{3}/2} \ge \frac{7}{8} e^{-1/2} r.$$

The pulse is nonnegative, so the convolution yields

$$q(1) \ge 2\frac{7}{8} e^{-1/2} \frac{64}{315} = \frac{16}{45\sqrt{e}}, \qquad C_* \ge \frac{3}{4} q(1)^2 \ge \frac{64}{675e} > 0. \tag{33}$$

This supplies the required nonzero terminal response without numerical quadrature.

Now set $a = 1$, $b = 2$, $\Delta = 2$, and declare the reading interval $[3, 7]$ with $\delta = 10^{-4}$. Both initial energies are $5E_f = 262144/9009$. For every time in this interval,

$$\begin{aligned} Y_{12}(t) - Y_{21}(t) &\ge \frac{64}{225e^5}(1 - e^{-2}) \\ &> \frac{16}{75\,3^5} > \frac{2}{10^4} = 2\delta. \end{aligned} \tag{34}$$

We used $2 < e < 3$, which follows from the factorial series, and hence $1 - e^{-2} > 3/4$. The last comparison is rational. The midpoint decoder therefore selects the order from a single reading at any specified time in $[3, 7]$.

This is a guarantee for ideal prepared data under a bounded scalar observation error. It does not certify a detector's access to $\dot{q}$, clock accuracy, pulse-shape accuracy or preparation errors. The statement at any specified time can be tested on separate prepared repetitions; no nondisturbing sequence of physical measurements is presumed. The energy comparison concerns the mathematical field data, not an omitted measurement apparatus.

3 Why the scalar does not close, and what does

3.1 The next pulse exposes discarded orientation

Keep the same base pulse with $C_* > 0$. Between successive pulse end times separated by $\Delta \geq T$, assume no incident input except one pulse βf occupying the final T units. Then

$$z_{n+1} = \Phi(\Delta) z_n + \beta c. \tag{35}$$

Indeed, the free contribution is the first term of (23); a change of variables in its integral gives exactly βc. Squaring gives

$$Y_{n+1} = e^{-\gamma\Delta} Y_n + \beta^2 C_* + 2\beta c^{\mathsf{T}} \Phi(\Delta) z_n. \tag{36}$$

The last term depends on the orientation of the current field–rate vector relative to the incoming pulse, not only its squared norm.

To decide whether this dependence is genuinely an obstruction, we must specify a family containing different states with the same scalar. We now enlarge the preparation family: any finite sequence of separated copies of f with arbitrary real amplitudes is allowed. All are prepared as initial incoming bulk profiles with the boundary initially at rest. The signed amplitudes are relative to one common preparation standard. The earlier two positive orders belong to this family, but do not exhaust it.

Lemma 3.1 (Reachable terminal vectors)**.** *Every real vector in $\mathbb{R}^2$ is a terminal state of two separated signed pulses of the fixed shape, at a common terminal time chosen as below.*

Proof. Choose $s \geq T$ with $\sin(\Omega s) \neq 0$. The two pulse supports can be $[0, T]$ and $[s, s + T]$, and their terminal vector is $\alpha\Phi(s)c + \beta c$. Since

$$\det[c, \Phi(s)c] = -e^{-\gamma s/2} \sin(\Omega s) C_* \neq 0, \tag{37}$$

these two vectors form a basis. Solving the real two-by-two linear system gives finite amplitudes for every desired vector. The preparation has finite energy $(\alpha^2 + \beta^2)E_f$ and satisfies the same initial and endpoint compatibility conditions as before. □

Proposition 3.2 (No universal scalar update on the enlarged family)**.** *Fix $\Delta \geq T$ and a next amplitude $\beta > 0$. There is no function $\mathcal{U}_\beta : [0, \infty) \to [0, \infty)$ such that $Y_{n+1} = \mathcal{U}_\beta(Y_n)$ for every reachable terminal state in Lemma 3.1 followed by that same next pulse.*

Proof. Let $d = \Phi(\Delta)^{\mathsf{T}} c \neq 0$ and $J = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$. For $R > 0$ choose

$$z^{(1)} = R\frac{d}{\|d\|}, \qquad z^{(2)} = R\frac{Jd}{\|d\|}. \tag{38}$$

Their squared norms are both R^2, whereas $d^{\mathsf{T}} z^{(1)} = R\,\|d\|$ and $d^{\mathsf{T}} z^{(2)} = 0$. The next scalar values from (36) differ by $2\beta R\,\|d\| > 0$. Both states are realizable by Lemma 3.1, and appending the same future pulse gives admissible complete incoming profiles. Thus the fibre condition (18) fails. □

The witnesses differ in orientation, not merely by a common sign. Their complete initial energies have not been constrained to agree. Equal energy was essential to the comparison in Proposition 2.1, but is not an assumption of this nonclosure proposition. Adding that constraint would require a separate argument.

In particular, the counterexample does not invalidate reading the two positive order labels. At a fixed reading time those labels have *different* scalars. On a family where a scalar uniquely identifies the allowed current state, one can predict the next scalar by identifying that state first. The obstruction concerns the declared larger family; it is not a prohibition of every finite-dimensional record.

3.2 A common phase sector and a supplied reference

The real vector z is already sufficient for (35) in its chosen real representative. To express that sufficiency without treating an absolute charged phase or sign as an observable, specify the following restricted complex description. On a trivial bundle let θ be smooth and write

$$\eta = e^{i\theta}, \qquad \Psi = \eta u, \qquad \Xi = \eta q, \qquad A_\mu = \partial_\mu \theta, \qquad D_\mu = \partial_\mu - iA_\mu. \tag{39}$$

Then $D_\mu \Psi = \eta \partial_\mu u$ and $D_t \Xi = \eta \dot{q}$. The curvature is zero, and currents proportional to $\mathrm{Im}(\overline{\Psi} D_\mu \Psi)$ vanish. This is the common phase orbit of the real neutral solutions, not arbitrary charged or independently phased input data. Substitution into the covariant versions of (4) gives exactly their real counterparts.

Under a gauge transformation with phase χ,

$$(\Psi, \Xi, \eta) \mapsto e^{i\chi}(\Psi, \Xi, \eta), \qquad A_\mu \mapsto A_\mu + \partial_\mu \chi.$$

The surface reference η is supplied by preparation and calibration, with $|\eta| = 1$ and $D_t \eta = 0$. It is not constructed by normalizing Ξ, and remains defined when $q = 0$. All future signed amplitudes are prepared relative to this same reference. Its physical maintenance and measurement are not supplied by a reference-field action here.

Define

$$w = \begin{pmatrix} \Omega \Xi \\ D_t \Xi + \gamma \Xi / 2 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad r = \overline{\eta}\, w \in \mathbb{R}^2. \tag{40}$$

Both components of w acquire the phase $e^{i\chi}$; its cancellation against the transformed $\overline{\eta}$ makes r gauge invariant. The corresponding scalar is

$$Y = w^\dagger w = \|r\|^2 = |D_t \Xi + \gamma \Xi / 2|^2 + \Omega^2 |\Xi|^2, \tag{41}$$

which reduces to (19). The scalar itself does not require reading the external phase standard. The standard is relevant to the larger record and its relation to later inputs.

Proposition 3.3 (Orbit separation for the reduced record)**.** *On*

$$\mathcal{P} = \{(w, \eta) : |\eta| = 1,\ \overline{\eta} w \in \mathbb{R}^2\},$$

r distinguishes the orbits of the simultaneous phase action on (w, η). It need not distinguish full bulk states or complete input histories.

Proof. Invariance has just been shown. If two pairs have the same r, then $w = \eta r$ and $w' = \eta' r$. The unit factor η'/η maps both members of the first pair to the second. Conversely a simultaneous phase change leaves r unchanged. The proof includes $w = 0$ because η never vanishes. □

This quotient statement neither derives access to r from access to Y nor proves that a phase reference is energetically free. It identifies the additional relation that is being made available.

3.3 Controlled closure and its limits

Along the surface between successive pulse end times, let

$$P_{n+1,n} = \exp\left(i \int_{t_n}^{t_{n+1}} A_0(t)\, dt \right), \qquad \eta_{n+1} = P_{n+1,n} \eta_n. \tag{42}$$

The positive exponent follows by integrating $D_t \eta = 0$. Under a gauge transformation the transport acquires $e^{i\chi_{n+1}}$ on the left and $e^{-i\chi_n}$ on the right. For the same input convention as in (35), the covariant update is

$$w_{n+1} = P_{n+1,n} \Phi(\Delta) w_n + \eta_{n+1} \beta_n c. \tag{43}$$

It follows by multiplying the real update by η_{n+1} and using $w_n = \eta_n z_n$. It is established only on the stipulated common-phase family.

Proposition 3.4 (Closed update with the reference and input supplied)**.** *On the common-phase family* (39)*, supply the parallel reference* (42)*. Between pulse end times separated by* $\Delta \geq T$*, admit only the prescribed next pulse* $\beta_n f$ *during the final* T *units, with no other incoming excitation. Then the relative record has the exact update*

$$r_{n+1} = \Phi(\Delta) r_n + \beta_n c. \tag{44}$$

Thus equal relative records with the same next pulse protocol give equal next relative records, and $Y_{n+1} = \|r_{n+1}\|^2$ *is determined.*

Proof. Multiply (43) by $\overline{\eta}_{n+1}$. Since $|P_{n+1,n}| = 1$ and $\overline{\eta}_{n+1} P_{n+1,n} = \overline{\eta}_n$, the transport cancels and (44) follows. □

Even the intrinsic matrix $ww^\dagger$ would not supply every relation to an independently specified next input. With the reference held fixed, r and $-r$ give the same matrix but their next squared norms differ by $4\beta c^\mathsf{T} \Phi(\Delta) r$, which is nonzero, for example, at $r = \Phi(\Delta)^\mathsf{T} c$. Such states are reachable by the signed preparations. Negating the past alone is not the simultaneous phase change of the past, reference and future input that gauge invariance would identify.

The enlarged record is sufficient, not proved minimal among all possible access rules. Nor is its controlled closure autonomous from the bulk: β_n, timing, shape and reference relation are specified resources. For example, $r_n = 0$ followed by no pulse gives a different next state from $r_n = 0$ followed by $\beta_n \neq 0$. Incorporating a future schedule in an enlarged state records that schedule; it does not generate it.

A common pulse also cannot restore a lost vector separation in this linear model. For two histories receiving the same next input,

$$r_{n+1}^{(1)} - r_{n+1}^{(2)} = \Phi(\Delta)(r_n^{(1)} - r_n^{(2)}), \qquad \left\| r_{n+1}^{(1)} - r_{n+1}^{(2)} \right\| = e^{-\gamma\Delta/2} \left\| r_n^{(1)} - r_n^{(2)} \right\|. \tag{45}$$

The common affine contribution cancels. A quadratic scalar gap may change because of its cross term with that contribution, but this is not amplification of the full vector record.

4 Interpretation, related work and limits

4.1 The scope of the three statements

Table 1 collects the domains rather than combining the results into one claim with unstated hypotheses. The fixed dynamics are shared, but the allowed preparations and available information are not identical in the three rows.

Statement	Family and supplied access	What is not implied
Order reading	Two positive orders at equal total energy; known time, calibration and scalar Y using field and rate	Decoding arbitrary histories or scalar closure on a larger family
Scalar nonclosure	Reachable signed-pulse histories; a common next input; the same current scalar	Nonclosure on the two-label family, equal energies of the witnesses, or failure of every finite record
Relative closure	Common-phase family; supplied reference and next pulse protocol; two real components	Minimality, autonomous input generation or persistent preservation of old labels

Table 1: Preparation and access assumptions are part of each statement.

The role of the field theory is concrete but limited. It supplies compatible finite-energy histories and a conservative account of the outgoing radiation. The observable distinction and the

obstruction to scalar updating are then read from a two-dimensional linear system. One should not replace that explanation by the assertion that an independent physical memory mechanism has been discovered.

4.2 Comparison with established constructions

A direct model comparison is available with George's boundary oscillator system[1, Section 2.1, Eqs. (14), (19)–(21)]. In canonically normalized coordinates $\varphi = \sqrt{K}\,u$ and $Q = \sqrt{M}\,q$, our Hamiltonian has the same form under the parameter specialization

$$m = 0, \qquad \lambda = \frac{g}{K}, \qquad \mu^2 = \frac{g}{M}, \qquad \beta_{\mathrm{G}} = -\frac{g}{\sqrt{KM}}. \tag{46}$$

Here β_{G} denotes that paper's coupling, not a pulse amplitude. Expanding our interaction energy verifies the comparison directly. The referenced treatment assumes positive bulk mass; this is a massless specialization of its displayed equations, not an import of its full spectral or quantum conclusions. The parameter map satisfies $\beta_{\mathrm{G}}^2 = \lambda\mu^2$, so at $m = 0$ George's bound-state polynomial factors as $\rho(\rho^2 + \lambda\rho + \mu^2)$ [1, Section 2.2]. Its zero root is not a positive inverse decay length and hence is not a localized bound-mode root. Our pulse solution and energy balance were proved independently. This comparison locates the model in an existing class rather than claiming a new coupling mechanism.

Earlier brane–bulk work also studies one-dimensional toy models coupling field dynamics to discrete boundary degrees of freedom, including string–oscillator analogues[2]. This is a close conceptual precedent, though not the same independent boundary coordinate and spring coupling used here.

Related field–mechanical systems have also been studied in interval models with endpoint point masses; Barbero et al. analyze their modes and quantization[3]. Dynamical Wentzell conditions for a Klein–Gordon field in anti-de Sitter spacetime provide another established bulk–boundary setting[4]. These works differ in geometry and boundary variables from the present massless half-line model. They confirm that boundary coupling and mode analysis are not the new result claimed here. The narrower question in this paper is the explicit pulse-order readout and scalar-update counterexample under the stated preparation and access rules; no priority claim is made for those constructions.

The state-space convolution and affine update are standard linear operations[5]. In the present example the order effect is obtained by cancelling the common cross terms in two squared norms. The explicit energy comparison and analytic error margin clarify the protocol, but should not be presented as a new law of linear response.

Horstmeyer and Atay characterize exact lumpability of smooth vector fields[6]. Their Proposition 2 relates the original and reduced flows by a commuting projection, with attention to the domains of definition. Equation (18) gives the elementary representative-independence condition needed here. It does not include their smoothness structure and is not a replacement theorem for that setting. The contribution of Proposition 3.2 is the explicit reachable pair that violates the condition for this observable.

Shalizi and Crutchfield construct causal states for prediction of stochastic processes and establish optimality and uniqueness properties[7]. Barnett and Crutchfield extend that approach to input–output processes and channel models[8, Sections VI and IX]. These provide the relevant distinction between a summary of the past and information sufficient for future prediction under specified inputs. Our deterministic finite pulse families have neither a probability law for input histories nor an information-theoretic minimization criterion. Consequently the relative vector is not identified with a proved minimal causal-state representation. The analogy motivates a careful access statement; it does not transfer those optimality results.

4.3 Resources, limitations and conclusion

The model, boundary location, clock, parameters and allowed input family are supplied rather than derived from Field 01. The decoder additionally uses calibrated signals at known times and assumes access to a rate-dependent scalar. The enlarged record requires a phase reference related to the incident preparation. The analysis does not test the cosmological claims of Field 01. The word *record* is used operationally for retained data supporting a declared reading or update task, not as evidence of such a principle.

The explicit guarantee is finite-time and has a declared deterministic error model. It does not establish robustness to arbitrary charged perturbations, finite-bandwidth detection, unknown timing or unknown waveforms. Even the ideal signal gap decays. The fully conservative bulk–boundary system can therefore support the stated temporary order code without providing permanent surface storage.

The construction isolates one useful distinction. A scalar surface observation reads a chosen equal-energy order label, but loses orientation needed for a common future input when the preparation family is enlarged. A relative two-component record retains that orientation and closes the specified controlled update. The difference between these statements is not a numerical precision issue: it is the difference between a label map on a restricted family and a state description adequate for an announced class of future operations.

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